Sultan Salic Manalusug Amai Manabilang Pangarungan

Sultan Salic Manalusug Amai Manabilang Pangarungan, known by his honorary title **Sultan Dimasangcay Sa Dansalan**, was a distinguished political leader and institutional steward who shaped the governance and educational landscape of Lanao del Sur for decades. His legacy lives on through his role as the longest-serving Senior Provincial Board Member of Lanao del Sur, his institutional leadership of the Pangarungan Islamic College, and the continued prominence of the Amai Manabilang-Pangarungan lineage in Maranao political and cultural life. A trusted appointee of President Ferdinand Marcos Sr., Sultan Salic navigated the complexities of Martial Law-era governance while maintaining his commitment to Maranao institutions and educational advancement. His leadership bridged traditional sultanate authority with modern provincial governance, establishing a political dynasty that continues to serve Lanao del Sur through his descendants.

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Background

Sultan Salic Manalusug Amai Manabilang Pangarungan was born into the prominent Amai Manabilang family, one of the most influential royal houses in Lanao del Sur. His father, Datu Pangarungan Desalongan, was a respected traditional leader who founded and led the Pangarungan Islamic College (PIC) and the Jameo Mindanao Al-Islamie Islamic Center, establishing a foundation for Islamic education in the region. The Amai Manabilang lineage carries deep historical significance in Maranao society, with ties to the traditional governance structures of the sultanate system that predated Philippine colonial rule.

Growing up in this environment of traditional authority and educational advocacy, Sultan Salic inherited both the political acumen and the commitment to Islamic scholarship that defined his family's contributions to Lanao. The Pangarungan name became synonymous with educational excellence and political leadership in the Islamic City of Marawi and the broader province of Lanao del Sur.

Political Career

Municipal Leadership

Sultan Salic began his public service career as Vice Mayor of the Islamic City of Marawi, the cultural and political heart of the Maranao people. In this role, he worked to advance the interests of Marawi's residents during a period of significant political transition in the Philippines. His service at the municipal level provided him with deep insights into the everyday governance challenges facing Lanao's urban center.

Provincial Governance

Sultan Salic's most enduring political legacy came through his service as a Provincial Board Member of Lanao del Sur, where he became the longest-standing Senior Provincial Board Member in the province's history. This remarkable tenure reflected both his political skill and the trust placed in him by Lanao del Sur's electorate.

During the Martial Law period under President Ferdinand Edralin Marcos Sr., Sultan Salic was appointed to key executive positions within the provincial government. He served as both Acting Governor and Vice Governor of Lanao del Sur, navigating the complex political landscape of authoritarian rule while representing the interests of the Maranao people. These appointments demonstrated the Marcos administration's recognition of Sultan Salic's leadership capabilities and his influence within Lanao's political circles.

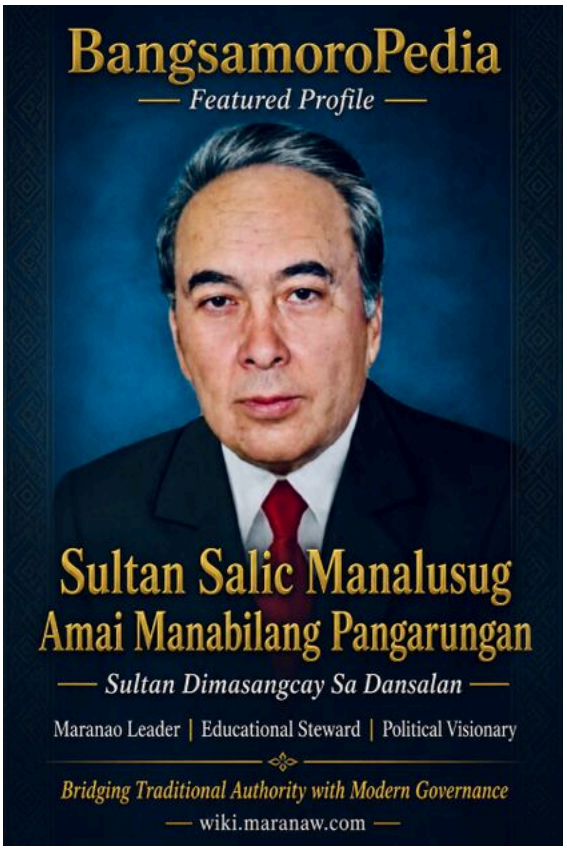
His provincial board service spanned multiple administrations and political eras, giving him a unique perspective on the evolution of local governance in Lanao del Sur from the Martial Law period through the restoration of democratic processes.

Institutional Leadership

Pangarungan Islamic College

Following the death of his father, Datu Pangarungan Desalongan, Sultan Salic assumed the presidency of the Pangarungan Islamic College (PIC), becoming its longest-serving president. Under his leadership, PIC continued its mission of providing Islamic education to students in Lanao del Sur, serving as a vital institution for the preservation and transmission of Islamic scholarship in the region.

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Honorary Title	Sultan Dimasangcay Sa Dansalan
Political Roles	Vice Mayor of Marawi Senior Provincial Board Member Acting Governor of Lanao del Sur Vice Governor of Lanao del Sur
Institutional Leadership	President, Pangarungan Islamic College President, Jameo Mindanao Al-Islamie Islamic Center
Father	Datu Pangarungan Desalongan
Notable Grandson	Saidamen Balt Pangarungan (Former Governor, Former NCMF Secretary, Former Comelec Chairman, Sultan of Madaya)
First Cousin	Sultan Mastura Amai Manabilang (Former Mayor, Sultan Sa Ranao)

His stewardship of PIC reflected his commitment to educational advancement and his dedication to maintaining the institutional legacy established by his father. The college became a cornerstone of Islamic learning in Mindanao, producing generations of scholars, religious leaders, and community servants.

Ethnic Affiliation	Maranao

Jameo Mindanao Al-Islamie Islamic Center

Sultan Salic also served as President of the Jameo Mindanao Al-Islamie Islamic Center, another institution founded by his father. This center played a crucial role in coordinating Islamic educational efforts across Mindanao and promoting cultural and religious understanding within the Muslim community. His leadership of both institutions demonstrated his dual commitment to formal Islamic education and broader community religious development.

Legacy and Family Succession

The Pangarungan-Amai Manabilang Dynasty

Sultan Salic's passing did not diminish the political and cultural influence of the Pangarungan-Amai Manabilang family. His favorite grandson, **Saidamen Balt Pangarungan**, emerged as a towering figure in Philippine politics and Maranao leadership. Saidamen Balt served as Governor of Lanao del Sur, Secretary of the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF), and Chairman of the Commission on Elections (Comelec), one of the most powerful constitutional bodies in the Philippines. Following his grandfather's legacy, Saidamen Balt assumed leadership of the Pangarungan Clan and currently holds the title of Sultan of Madaya in the Islamic City of Marawi.

Sultan Salic's youngest son, **Cabugatan Sa Bacolod Anwar Tahir Malomalo Amai Manabilang**, continues the family's engagement with traditional governance structures as the current Chairman of the Marawi Sultanate League, an organization that coordinates the activities of Marawi's various sultanates and preserves traditional Maranao leadership systems.

Family Connections

Sultan Salic's family ties extended to other prominent Maranao political families. He was first cousin to **Sultan Mastura Amai Manabilang**, who served as Mayor and holds the title of Sultan Sa Ranao. This familial connection further solidified the Amai Manabilang family's central role in both traditional sultanate governance and modern electoral politics in Lanao del Sur.

The continued prominence of Sultan Salic's descendants in provincial governance, national politics, and traditional sultanate leadership demonstrates the enduring impact of his political and institutional work. His grandson Saidamen Balt, highly respected by the family, represents the successful transition of leadership across generations while maintaining the family's commitment to public service.

Recognition and Influence

Sultan Salic's honorary title, **Sultan Dimasangcay Sa Dansalan**, reflected his status within the traditional Maranao sultanate system and his connection to the historical governance structures of Lanao. The title "Dansalan" refers to the traditional name for what is now the Islamic City of Marawi, emphasizing his deep roots in the region's

political and cultural heritage.

His dual role as both an elected official under the Philippine government structure and a sultan within the traditional Maranao system exemplified the complex political landscape of Muslim Mindanao, where modern democratic institutions coexist with centuries-old sultanate governance. Sultan Salic successfully navigated both worlds, earning respect in the halls of provincial government and in the traditional councils of Maranao royalty.

Impact on Lanao del Sur

Sultan Salic Manalusug Amai Manabilang Pangarungan's decades of service left an indelible mark on Lanao del Sur's political institutions and educational landscape. His record as the longest-serving Senior Provincial Board Member established a standard of longevity and consistent leadership that few have matched. His stewardship of the Pangarungan Islamic College and Jameo Mindanao Al-Islamie Islamic Center ensured the continuation of his father's educational mission and provided opportunities for Islamic learning across generations.

The political dynasty he helped establish continues to influence Lanao del Sur's governance, with his descendants holding positions of authority at the provincial, national, and traditional sultanate levels. His life exemplified the unique character of Maranao political leadership: rooted in traditional royal lineage, committed to Islamic scholarship, and engaged with the modern structures of Philippine democracy.

See Also

- Saidamen Balt Pangarungan
- Islamic City of Marawi
- Sultanate of Lanao
- Lanao del Sur
- Amai Manabilang Family
- National Commission on Muslim Filipinos

References

- Profile provided by Mark Pangarungan (https://www.facebook.com/mpangarungan1)

External Links

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